

D. After he had a "Eureka!" moment, Lane financed Penguin books and initially acquired the rights to ten reprints.

99. Born Agnes Bojaxhiu in 1910, Mother Teresa attended a convent-run primary school and then a state-run secondary school. The congregation made an annual pilgrimage to the chapel of the Madonna of Letnice atop Black Mountain in Skopje, and it was on one such trip at the age of twelve that Mother Teresa first felt a calling to a religious life. In 1928, an 18-year-old Agnes Bojaxhiu decided to become a nun and set off for Ireland to join the Loreto Sisters of Dublin. It was there that she took the name Sister Mary Teresa after Saint Thérèse of Lisieux. A year later, she travelled on to Darjeeling, India for the novitiate period; afterward she was sent to Calcutta, where she was assigned to teach at Saint Mary's High School for Girls, a school dedicated to teaching girls from the city's poorest Bengali families. Mother Teresa had to learn to speak both Bengali and Hindi fluently as she taught geography and history and dedicated herself to alleviating the girls' poverty through education. (*biography.com*)

A. Had Agnes Bojaxhiu not joined her congregation on a pilgrimage to Skopje, she might never have felt a religious calling.

B. Agnes Bojaxhiu first took the name of Sister Mary Teresa on a trip to Darjeeling, India with the Loreto Sisters.

C. Mother Teresa taught history and geography in Bengali and Hindi at Saint Mary's High School for Girls in Calcutta.

D. After Agnes Bojaxhiu felt a religious calling, she became a nun and eventually travelled to Darjeeling and Calcutta and never left India again.

100. Prior to the 17th century, Ottoman succession had been governed by the "law of fratricide" drawn up by Mehmed II in the middle of the 15th century. Under the terms of this remarkable piece of legislation, whichever member of the ruling dynasty succeeded in seizing the throne on the death of the old sultan was not merely permitted, but enjoined, to murder all his brothers (together with

any inconvenient uncles and cousins) in order to reduce the risk of subsequent rebellion and civil war. Although it was not invariably applied, Mehmed's law resulted in the deaths of at least 80 members of the House of Osman over a period of 150 years. These victims included all 19 siblings of Sultan Mehmed III – some of whom were still infants at the breast, but all of whom were strangled with silk handkerchiefs immediately after their brother's accession in 1595. (*smithsonianmag.com*)

A. Without the "law of fratricide", chaos and coups would have reigned in the Ottoman empire between the 15th and 17th centuries.

B. During the 15th century, the Ottoman Mehmed II instituted legislation that commanded a new ruler to commit fratricide.

C. The murder of the 19 siblings of Sultan Mehmed III was the most appalling incident of fratricide in the Ottoman succession between the 15th and 17th centuries.

D. Between the 15th and 17th centuries all family members of the new ruler were murdered in order to reduce the risk of subsequent rebellion and civil war.

101. Twins offer a precious opportunity to untangle the influence of genes and the environment – of nature and nurture. Because identical twins come from a single fertilised egg that splits in two, they share virtually the same genetic code. Any differences between them – one twin having younger looking skin, for example – must be due to environmental factors such as less time spent in the sun. Alternatively, by comparing the experiences of identical twins with those of fraternal twins, who come from separate eggs and share on average half their DNA, researchers can quantify the extent to which our genes affect our lives. If identical twins are more similar to each other with respect to an ailment than fraternal twins are, then vulnerability to the disease must be rooted at least in part in heredity. Lately, however, twin studies have helped lead scientists to a radical, almost heretical new conclusion: that nature and nurture are not the only elemental forces at work. (*National Geographic*)

- A. Fraternal twins are more suitable than identical twins for studying how our environment impacts our lives.
- B. Studies of identical and fraternal twins indicate that we are equally influenced by our genetics and our environment.
- C. If one fraternal twin suffers from a disease while the other twin does not, the cause of the disease is hereditary.
- D. Identical twins share nearly 100 per cent of their DNA while, on average, fraternal twins share 50 per cent of their DNA.

102. A decision by Serbia's parliament to limit the independence of the national bank has been described by the European Union as a "step back" in the country's bid to join the EU. A spokesperson for Štefan Füle, the European commissioner for enlargement and neighbourhood policy, said that the Commission was "deeply concerned" by the amendments, adopted on Saturday (4 July). "The adoption of these amendments is a considerable step back in the alignment of Serbia's legislation with the [EU's] acquis in this area," he said. The law creates a supervisory body with influence on the management of the bank and possibly on monetary decision-making. Its members are to be appointed by parliament, where the coalition of Progressives and Socialists holds a majority. Vladimir Gligorov, an economist at the Vienna Institute for International Economic Studies, said that the significance of the law should not be overstated. (*European Voice*)

- A. Legislation on the national bank recently passed by the Serbian parliament supposedly enhances the country's chances of becoming a member of the EU.
- B. The Serbian parliament referenced EU policy when creating a national bank supervisory body with members appointed by parliament.
- C. Comments made by economist Vladimir Gligorov suggest that Serbia still has a good chance of joining the EU.
- D. The Serbian parliament passed legislation that tightens controls on the national bank in part by the creation of a supervisory body.

103. A new Internet-enabled power outlet will soon allow users to control household appliances via their smartphones and

reduce their energy costs significantly. Soon there will be no need for special timers to switch lighting on and off or operate household appliances when the homeowner is absent. In the future, all of these things will be doable by means of a smartphone or PC thanks to Internet-enabled wireless power outlets that support the IPv6 Internet protocol. The wireless power outlets are a component of the HexaBus home automation system. "The HexaBus components make the smart home of the future a reality. They enable household appliances to be controlled intelligently, thus optimizing or reducing electricity consumption. For example, the householder can start the washing machine during cheap-rate off-peak hours, or run the dishwasher when the photovoltaic panels on the roof are generating sufficient power," says industrial engineer Mathias Dalheimer. (*Science Daily*)

- A. Homes equipped with Internet-enabled power outlets will automatically optimise or reduce the household's use of electricity without any human control.
- B. The HexaBus home automation system will soon be installed in the majority of smart homes that support the IPv6 Internet protocol.
- C. Soon homeowners can start a load of laundry remotely with a smartphone or PC and Internet-enabled wireless power outlets.
- D. When homeowners can control appliances and lighting from their smartphone or PC, energy consumption will drop.

104. Not only are healthy organs in short supply but donor and patient also have to be closely matched, or the patient's immune system may reject the transplant. A new kind of solution is incubating in medical labs: "bioartificial" organs grown from the patient's own cells. Thirty people have received lab-grown bladders already, and other engineered organs are in the pipeline. Researchers take healthy cells from a patient's diseased bladder, cause them to multiply profusely in petri dishes, then apply them to a balloon-shaped scaffold made partly of collagen, the protein found in cartilage. Muscle cells go on the outside, urothelial cells (which line the urinary tract) on the inside. "It's like baking a layer cake," says Atala. "You're layering

the cells one layer at a time, spreading these toppings." The bladder-to-be is then incubated at body temperature until the cells form functioning tissue. The whole process takes six to eight weeks. (*National Geographic*)

- A. A lab-grown bioartificial bladder is made by layering urothelial cells around muscle cells.
- B. To grow a bladder in a lab, researchers must take some of the patient's healthy collagen cells.
- C. A lab-grown bioartificial bladder involves petri dishes, a scaffold, cell layering, and incubation.
- D. After bladder cells are transferred to the scaffold, they remain there for a period of three weeks.

105. Recent studies indicate that the brain's insular cortex may help a sprinter drive his body forward just a little more efficiently than his competitors. This region may prepare a boxer to better fend off a punch his opponent is beginning to throw as well as assist a diver as she calculates her spinning body's position so she hits the water with barely a splash. The insula does all this by anticipating an athlete's future feelings, according to a new theory. Researchers suggest that an athlete possesses a hyper-attuned insula that can generate strikingly accurate predictions of how the body will feel in the next moment. That model of the body's future condition instructs other brain areas to initiate actions that are more tailored to coming demands than those of also-rans and couch potatoes. Emerging evidence now also suggests that this brain area can be trained using a meditation technique called mindfulness – good news for Olympians and weekend warriors alike. (*smithsonianmag.com*)

- A. Research shows that the brain's insular cortex can be tuned only by physically practising a given sport or skill.
- B. The insular cortex may contribute to athletic excellence by anticipating how the physical body will soon feel.
- C. Sprinters, boxers and divers are those athletes who benefit most from a hyper-attuned insular cortex.
- D. Research indicates that, compared to boxers, athletes have larger insular cortices.

106. The British mathematician Alan Turing probed one of computing's biggest theoretical questions: Could machines possess a mind? If so, how would we know? In 1950, he proposed an experiment: If judges in typed conversations with a person and a computer programme couldn't tell them apart, we'd come to consider the machine as "thinking." He predicted that programmes would be capable of fooling judges 30 per cent of the time by the year 2000. They came closest at the 2008 Loebner Prize competition when the top chatbot (as a human-mimicking programme is called) fooled 3 of 12 judges, or 25 per cent. Chatbots betray themselves in many ways, some subtle. They're unlikely to gracefully interrupt or be interrupted. Their responses, often cobbled together out of fragments of stored conversations, make sense at a local level but lack long-term coherence. (*smithsonianmag.com*)

- A. A chatbot tricked a quarter of the judges into thinking it was human at the 2008 Loebner Prize competition.
- B. The absence of sustained logical consistency most frequently alerts Turing test judges that they are talking to a chatbot.
- C. Turing's prediction that computers would trick people 30 per cent of the time by the year 2000 was proven correct.
- D. Within the next several years, chatbots will be able to adequately imitate how humans interrupt and are interrupted.

107. The predominant theory of sleep is that the brain demands it. But the trick is to confirm this assumption with real data. How does sleeping help the brain? The answer may depend on what kind of sleep you are talking about. Recently, researchers at Harvard tested undergraduates on various aptitude tests, allowed them to nap, then tested them again. They found that those who had engaged in REM sleep subsequently performed better in pattern recognition tasks, such as grammar, while those who slept deeply were better at memorisation. Other researchers have found that the sleeping brain appears to repeat a pattern of neuron firing that occurred while the subject was recently awake, as if in

sleep the brain were trying to commit to long-term memory what it had learned that day. Yet another study showed that the sleeping brain seems to weed out redundant or unnecessary synapses or connections. So the purpose of sleep may be to help us remember what's important by letting us forget what's not. (*National Geographic*)

- A. According to the study referenced, REM sleep is the most valuable in assisting memorisation.
- B. The patterned neuron firing that occurs during REM sleep facilitates long-term memory.
- C. Removing unneeded synapses while asleep allows us to recognise patterns while awake.
- D. Some research shows that sleep may facilitate better pattern recognition and memory.

108. **Bingo Friendly**, developed by the British online gambling company Gamesys, was introduced on Facebook this morning. It allows players to stake cash in 90 bingo and slot machine games. The app is marketed with cartoon graphics featuring characters that have been compared to those on Moshi Monsters, the popular children's social network. It has prompted anger from Christian groups, who called on the Advertising Standards Authority to act. Facebook has allowed the first real gambling app as it comes under unprecedented pressure to increase its revenues. Since its flotation in May the firm has reported a \$157m loss and its shares have almost halved in value amid concerns about Facebook's effectiveness as an advertising medium. Facebook will take 30 per cent of revenues from Bingo Friendly and a host of other gambling apps expected to be introduced in the coming months. (*Daily Telegraph*)

- A. Christian groups angered by Bingo Friendly believe that children should not be exposed to the sin of gambling.
- B. Facebook will not benefit financially from Bingo Friendly or any other gambling app to appear on the site.
- C. Facebook shares lost half their value primarily because investors do not have faith in the company's advertising.
- D. Bingo Friendly appeared on Facebook at a time when the company was suffering from economic loss.

109. François Hollande, France's first Socialist president since François Mitterrand in the 1980s, is vowing to impose a 75 per cent tax on the portion of anyone's income above a million euros (\$1.24 million) a year. The 75 per cent tax proposal, which Parliament plans to take up in September, is ostensibly aimed at bolstering French finances as Europe's long-running debt crisis intensifies. But because there are relatively few people in France whose income would incur such a tax – perhaps no more than 30,000 in a country of 65 million – the gains might contribute but a small fraction of the 33 billion euros in new revenue the government wants to raise next year to help balance the budget. Some analysts note that a tax hit on the rich would provide political cover for painful cuts Mr. Hollande may need to make next year in social and welfare programmes that are likely to be far less popular with the rank and file. (*New York Times*)

- A. Analysts say that France can balance its budget with deep spending cuts together with the 75 per cent tax.
- B. François Hollande's proposed 75 per cent tax will unquestionably generate enough funds to balance France's budget.
- C. As many as 30,000 people in France could soon be subject to a 75 per cent tax on their annual income.
- D. The main reason for imposing a 75 per cent tax is to provide political cover for painful cuts France may need to make next year in social and welfare programmes.

110. Thomas, or Doubting Thomas as he is commonly known, was one of the "Twelve Apostles", disciples sent out after Christ's Crucifixion to spread the newborn faith. He was joined by Peter, Andrew, James the Greater, James the Lesser, John, Philip, Bartholomew, Matthew, Thaddaeus, Simon – and Matthias, who replaced the former disciple and alleged traitor, Judas Iscariot. In time the terms "apostle" and "apostolic" (derived from the Greek *apostolos*, or messenger) were applied to others who spread the word. In the case of Paul, he claimed the title of apostle for himself, believing he had seen the Lord and received a spiritual commission from him. Mary Magdalene is known

as the apostle to the Apostles for her role of announcing the resurrection to them. Although only two of the four Evangelists – Matthew and John – were amongst the original Apostles, Mark and Luke are considered apostolic because of the importance of their work in writing the New Testament Gospels. (*National Geographic*)

- A. For at least a century following the crucifixion, the word “apostle” was only used in reference to Christ’s twelve disciples.
- B. Simon, Philip and Mary Magdalene are all considered apostles, a term that traces to the Greek word meaning messenger.
- C. Despite their contributions to the New Testament, some conservative Christians still do not consider Mark and Luke to be apostles.
- D. The twelve apostles are Thomas, Peter, Andrew, James the Greater, James the Lesser, John, Philip, Bartholomew, Matthew, Thaddaeus, Simon, and Judas Iscariot.

111. The 17th century Dutch painter Frans Hals made two great contributions. One was to combine an intense sense of realism with flamboyant brushwork – which gives his work a highly personal quality. Hals’ other contribution is to fill his paintings with evident psychological intensity, the quality known as “psychological insight.” His figures feel as if we could speak to them. It’s surely no accident that Hals’s life (1580–1666) overlapped with that of Shakespeare (1564–1616), and the way he evoked a sense of character provides interesting parallels to the characters in Shakespeare’s plays who are generally two or more people in one body, engaged in internal dialogue. In that sense, Hals’s portraits document the emergence of the modern self: they display a new awareness that the “self” is not a single, uniform thing, but the product of conflicting forces and disparate impulses, ruled by a consciousness filled with self-doubt. (*smithsonianmag.com*)

- A. Frans Hals’ use of subtle brushwork in his paintings conveyed his impression of the people he painted.
- B. Frans Hals’s paintings have been described as conveying a sense of realism along with psychological insight.

- C. In his portraits, Frans Hals intentionally tried to impart a sense of the modern self, riddled with complexity and doubt.
- D. Hals frequently attended performances of Shakespeare’s plays, and the bard’s influence on his painting is obvious.

112. A new genetic analysis has reconstructed the history of North Africa’s Jews, showing that these populations date to biblical-era Israel and are not largely the descendants of natives who converted to Judaism. The study also shows that these Jews form two distinct groups, one of which is more closely related than the other to their European counterparts, reflecting historical migrations. The findings are the latest in a series of genetic studies, which began in the 1990s, indicating that the world’s Jews share biological roots, not just cultural and religious ties. In many cases the analyses have confirmed what scholars had gleaned from archaeological finds and historical accounts. The scientists found that the Jewish populations of North Africa became genetically distinct over time, with those of each country carrying their own DNA signatures. This suggests they mostly married within their own religious and cultural group. (*Science Daily*)

- A. Genetic analysis shows that the ancestors of North African Jews share biological roots with at least two other groups.
- B. Forced segregation prevented the Jews of North Africa from marrying outside their culture and religion.
- C. Country-specific Jewish populations in North Africa each have their own unique genetic markers.
- D. Studies consistently show that while Jews are culturally and religiously similar, they are biologically dissimilar.

113. Paris has a deeper and stranger connection to its underground than almost any city, and that underground is one of the richest. The arteries and intestines of Paris, the hundreds of miles of tunnels that make up some of the oldest and densest subway and sewer networks in the world, are just the start of it. Under Paris there are spaces of all

kinds: canals and reservoirs, crypts and bank vaults, wine cellars transformed into nightclubs and galleries. Most surprising of all are the *carrières* – the old limestone quarries that fan out in a deep and intricate web under many neighbourhoods, mostly in the southern part of the metropolis. Into the 19th century those caverns and tunnels were mined for building stone. After that farmers raised mushrooms in them, at one point producing hundreds of tons a year. During World War II, French Resistance fighters – the underground – hid in some quarries; the Germans built bunkers in others. (*National Geographic*)

- A. Underground limestone mining was primarily carried out under the northern part of Paris into the 19th century.
- B. Today, anyone is welcome to visit the many galleries, nightclubs, and other establishments underneath Paris.
- C. Underneath Paris, one can find *carrières*, bank vaults, galleries, sewers, nightclubs, tunnels, crypts, and caverns.
- D. At one point in Paris' history, the tons of mushrooms produced beneath ground were most likely more than the amount produced above ground.

114. More than 200,000 individual animal species, by varying strategies, help flowers make more flowers. Flies and beetles are the original pollinators, going back to when flowering plants first appeared 130 million years ago. As for bees, scientists have identified some 20,000 distinct species so far, and about one-fifth of those pollinate flowers in the United States. Hummingbirds, butterflies, moths, wasps, and ants are also up to the task. Snails and slugs smear pollen as they slide over flower clusters. Mosquitoes carry pollen for batches of orchids, and bats, with diverse muzzles and tongues adapted to tap differently shaped blossoms, move pollen for 360 plants in the Americas alone. Flowering plants – there are more than 240,000 species of them – have evolved in step with their pollinators, using sweet scents and bright colours to lure with the promise of a meal. Flower receptacles are wonderfully varied, from tubes and gullets to flaps, brushes, and spurs. (*National Geographic*)

- A. At the time plants began flowering on the planet 130 million years ago, among others flies, beetles, bees and bats spread their pollen.
- B. More than 240,000 species of flowering plants are pollinated by more than 200,000 animal species, including ants and bats.
- C. Hundreds of plants have evolved to match the tongue shape of some bat species that pollinate them.
- D. While beetles, snails, and bees all serve to pollinate plants, only the mosquito can carry pollen for orchids.

115. The income stagnation of the last decade stems, in the simplest terms, from two factors: a slowdown in economic growth and a rise in inequality, which has concentrated the economy's modest gains among a small share of the population. The economy's recent struggles began in late 2001, when a relatively mild recession ended and a new expansion began. The problem with this new recovery was that it wasn't especially strong. In addition to slow growth, the bounty from the economy's growth has largely flowed to a small slice of the population: the affluent. Since 2000, no income group has done particularly well. Income in households that rely on wages has failed to keep pace with inflation, while in households that have large investment holdings the value of many of those holdings – both real estate and stocks – has fallen. (*New York Times*)

- A. Although the rich have benefited from recent economic gains, no income group has flourished since 2000.
- B. Over the past decade, individuals with investment holdings in stocks and real estate have experienced only gains.
- C. The slow growth accompanying the weak economic recovery in 2001 did not contribute to current troubles.
- D. A faster rate of economic growth would allow even modest gains to flow more evenly among income groups.

116. The oldest extant play and the only surviving Greek tragedy about a contemporaneous (rather than mythological) topic, *The Persians* was written by Aeschylus in 472 BC. The play chronicles the 480 BC Battle of Salamis,

one of the most significant battles in world history: As the turning point in the Persian Empire's downfall, it allowed the Greeks – and therefore the West's first experiment with democracy – to survive. Aeschylus, a veteran of the Persian Wars, also made the unusual choice of recounting the battle from the Persian perspective, creating what's generally seen as an empathetic, rather than triumphalist, narrative of their loss. Today, the play is unexpectedly trendy. It has been produced about 30 times over the last five years. Why? Consider the plot: a superpower's inexperienced, hubristic leader – who hopes to conquer a minor enemy his father tried unsuccessfully to fell a decade earlier – charges into a doomed military invasion. (smithsonianmag.com)

- A. *The Persians* has enjoyed a renaissance in recent years because of its insight into the history of the Persian Empire.
- B. In *The Persians*, Greek playwright Aeschylus tells of the Battle of Salamis from the Greek point of view.
- C. *The Persians* is popular with contemporary audiences because it proves that history repeats itself.
- D. Aeschylus, who fought in the Persian Wars, provides an empathetic account of how the Persians lost the Battle of Salamis in 480 BC.

117. We now know that Stonehenge was in the making for at least 400 years. The first phase, built around 3000 BC, was a simple circular earthwork enclosure similar to many "henges" (sacred enclosures typically comprising a circular bank and a ditch) found throughout the British Isles. Around 2800 BC, timber posts were erected within the enclosure. Archaeologists have long believed that Stonehenge began to take on its modern form two centuries later, when large stones were brought to the site in the third and final stage of its construction. The first to be put in place were the 80 or so bluestones, which were arranged in a double circle with an entrance facing northeast. The importance of the bluestones is underscored by the immense effort involved in moving them a long distance – some were as long as three metres and weighed

four tons. Geological studies in the 1920s determined that they came from the Preseli Mountains in southwest Wales, 140 miles from Stonehenge. (smithsonianmag.com)

- A. Stonehenge was constructed in two main stages: first it was a circle-shaped enclosure and then the large stones were added.
- B. Research suggests that the bluestones of Stonehenge were moved from their source 140 miles away using only manpower.
- C. According to archaeologists, the bluestones of Stonehenge were added to the structure around 2800 BC.
- D. Around 2600 BC, bluestones from southwest Wales were added to the Stonehenge site in a double circle.

118. Children who think their parents are poor monitors or nag a lot tend to play videogames more than other kids, according to a study funded by the National Science Foundation. The study is one of the first to link parental behaviour to kids' videogame playing. The researchers surveyed more than 500 students from 20 middle schools and found that the more children perceived their parents' behaviour as negative (e.g., "nags a lot") and the less monitoring parents did, the more the children played videogames. The next step, said lead researcher Linda Jackson, is to find out what's fueling children's videogame behaviour – a topic Jackson and her team plan to examine. Jackson said an equally interesting question is the relationship between videogame playing and actual rather than perceived behaviour of parents. Perceptions don't always mirror reality, she said, and this may be the case in the child-parent relationship. (Science Daily)

- A. According to a study, children play more videogames if they perceive that they have parents who closely supervise them.
- B. Videogame playing causes children to interpret their parents' behaviour toward them as negative.
- C. According to a study, children who think their parents pester them a lot play more videogames.
- D. Research shows that children who play a lot of videogames are less likely to have parents who behave positively.

119. Walking upright on two legs is the trait that defines the hominid lineage: Bipedalism separated the first hominids from the rest of the four-legged apes. It took a while for anthropologists to realise this. At the turn of the 20th century, scientists thought that big brains made hominids unique. This was a reasonable conclusion since the only known hominid fossils were of brainy species – Neanderthals and *Homo erectus*. In more recent decades, anthropologists have determined that bipedalism has very ancient roots. The earliest hominid with the most extensive evidence for bipedalism is the 4.4-million-year-old *Ardipithecus ramidus*. Although the earliest hominids were capable of upright walking, they retained primitive features – such as long, curved fingers and toes as well as longer arms and shorter legs – that indicate they spent time in trees. It's not until the emergence of *H. erectus* 1.89 million years ago that hominids grew tall, evolved long legs and became completely terrestrial creatures. (*smithsonianmag.com*)
- A. Fossils indicate that *Ardipithecus ramidus* became the first fully bipedal and terrestrial species 4.4 million years ago.
- B. Fossils of Neanderthals suggest that the hominid species walked upright but was better at climbing trees.
- C. Hominid species with shorter legs, longer arms, and fingers and toes that curl likely spent at least some time in trees.
- D. Hominid species developed bigger brains just after they walked upright – around 4.4 million years ago.
120. In the warfare that raged in Cambodia from 1970 until 1998, all sides used land mines. There are more than 30 different types. Villagers have prosaic names for them based on their appearance: the frog, the drum, the corn cob. Most were manufactured in China, Russia, or Vietnam, a few in the United States. Khmer Rouge commander Pol Pot, whose regime was responsible for the deaths of some 1.7 million Cambodians between 1975 and 1979, purportedly called land mines his “perfect soldiers.” They never sleep. Although weapons of war, land mines are unlike bullets and bombs in two distinct ways. First, they are designed to maim rather than kill, because an injured soldier requires the help of two or three others, reducing the enemy's forces. Second, and most sinister, when a war ends, land mines remain in the ground, primed to explode. Only 25 per cent of land mine victims around the world are soldiers. The rest are civilians – boys gathering firewood, mothers sowing rice, girls herding goats. (*National Geographic*)
- A. Land mines are different from some other weapons of war in that their intent is not to kill but to disable.
- B. In Cambodia between 1975 and 1979, 75 per cent of land mine victims were civilians.
- C. “Perfect soldiers” is one of many names that only Cambodian villagers use to describe land mines.
- D. As weapons of war, land mines are more successful at reducing soldier forces than bullets or bombs.
121. Our working memory capacity is decidedly finite – it reflects our ability to focus and control attention and strongly influences our ability to solve problems. Converging evidence from many psychological science studies suggests that high working memory capacity is associated with better performance at mathematical problem-solving. In fact, decreased working memory capacity may be one reason why math anxiety leads to poor math performance. Overall, working memory capacity seems to help analytical problem-solvers focus their attention and resist distraction. However, these very features of working memory capacity seem to impair creative problem-solving. With creative problems, reaching a solution may require an original approach or a novel combination of diverse pieces of information. As a result, too much focus may actually impair creative problem solving. (*Science Daily*)
- A. Scientific studies suggest that people who tend to be anxious are better able to solve problems creatively.
- B. Scientific evidence indicates that a razor-sharp focus likely helps people to creatively solve problems.